United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime

AIRCOP CONTAINER CONTROL PROGRAMME

World Customs Organization
Organisation mondiale des douanes

THE WEEKLY NEWSLETTER

SEIZURE WATCH

WEEK
44
24 Oct – 30 Oct 2026

1,796 seizure reports from 89 countries, 13% more than the week before. 109 were rated high risk. Cannabis (449) and cocaine (356) led the reports.

1,796	109	395 t	56
SEIZURE REPORTS	HIGH RISK	REPORTED WEIGHT	CONTAINER CASES
▲ 13% vs prior week	▲ 30% vs prior week	▼ 26% vs prior week	

TOP STORIES



TOP STORY

ELEPHANT IVORY THAILAND

Over 3 tonnes of elephant tusks, ivory seized at Laem Chabang port

Elephant ivory, 3,000 kg; seized in Laem Chabang, Thailand; route Zambia to Thailand; hidden in container structure / false compartment.

Photo and report: Bangkok Post

READ THE REPORT →



METHAMPHETAMINE

UNITED STATES

National First Responders Day: Kern County Sheriff's Office KC-HIDTA: Drug task force dismantles multiple meth conversion labs in months-long operations

Methamphetamine, 971 kg; seized in San Bernardino, United States; hidden in legitimate cargo (food/produce).

Photo and report: Bakersfield.com



NSA

LITHUANIA

Over 800 kg seized: Polish police help bust one of Baltic states' largest drug labs

NSA, 800 kg; seized in Lithuania; route China to Czech Republic; hidden in legitimate cargo (industrial/goods).

Photo and report: TVP World



METHAMPHETAMINE

UNITED STATES

24 Charged in Massive Tennessee Cartel Drug Seizure

Methamphetamine, 500 kg; seized in Tennessee, United States; hidden in legitimate cargo (industrial/goods).

Photo and report: The UC Now

RISK WATCH: HIGHEST-RISK EVENTS

85	26 Oct	**Elephant ivory 3.0 t**	Laem Chabang, Thailand · Zambia → Thailand
80	26 Oct	**Cigarettes 440 kg**	Manchester, United Kingdom
75	29 Oct	**Methamphetamine 500 kg**	Tennessee, United States
75	28 Oct	**Methamphetamine 971 kg**	San Bernardino, United States
75	28 Oct	**Cocaine 3.1 t**	Malaga, Mexico
75	28 Oct	**Cocaine**	Callao, Peru

ALSO MAKING NEWS

- Nearly Five Million Illegal Cigarettes Seized at Manchester Airport
- Thailand seizes over 3.1 tonnes of ivory hidden in timber from Zambia

- Police strike against organized crime: 2.5 tons of hashish and 600 kilos of cocaine seized and eight criminals arrested
- Offshore chase: 568 kilos of cocaine seized and three Dominicans captured in a coordinated operation between Colombia, the Dominican Republic and the US.
- Doc caught with luggage full of ecstasy, psychedelic chocolates, marijuana edibles: police
- EIA is at CITES Standing Committee in Geneva to press for action on key endangered species
- Record amounts of Canadian cannabis seized as smuggling to Europe soars

THE WEEK IN NUMBERS

Reports by risk band — High 109 — Medium 611 — Low 1,076



REPORTS PER DAY

Sat 24	122
Sun 25	198
Mon 26	257
Tue 27	265
Wed 28	355
Thu 29	292
Fri 30	307

MOST REPORTED DRUGS AND GOODS

Cannabis	449
Cocaine	356
NSA	184
Heroin/Opium	161
Methamphetamine	116
Firearms	113
Ammunition	106
Unspecified	99

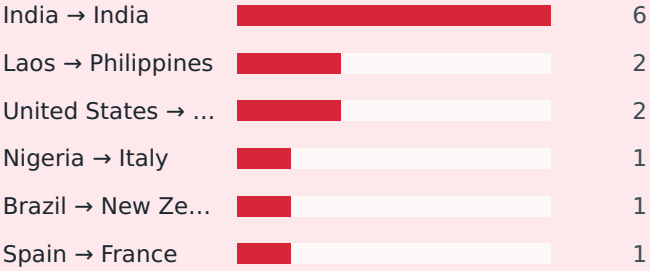
WHAT WAS SEIZED

Drug	1,365
Arms and ammu…	236
Tobacco	80
Cultural heritage	48
CITES protected …	29
Hazardous chem…	14

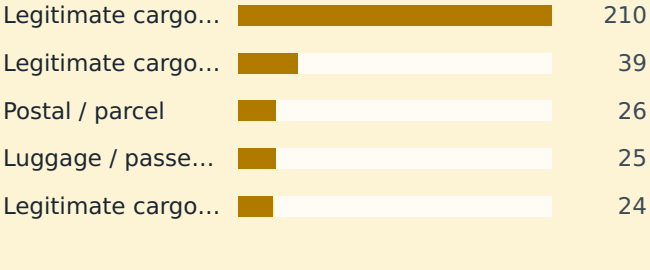
WHERE SEIZURES WERE MADE

India	307
Brazil	264
United States	201
Turkey	155
Mexico	86
Canada	54
Egypt	54
United Kingdom	34

BUSIEST ROUTES



HOW IT WAS HIDDEN



These are leads from open news sources, not confirmed facts. Verify before acting. Counts reflect what the tool found in the news it searches; a quiet country may mean no news or no coverage. Photos belong to the cited outlets and link back to their articles. Data runs to 2026-10-31.